BUILDER, STEP 15

Same task, 3 modes. Only one changed the file.

Our test of plan mode, permission modes and rewind in Claude Code.

OUR TEST

Nobody said yes. Two modes left the file alone.

	MANUAL	PLAN	ACCEPT EDITS
File	Unchanged	Unchanged	**Changed, right**
Seconds	80	26	31
Blocked	3 commands + 1 write	Nothing	3 commands

Task: add a column checked, with the value no. Same made-up export, one run per mode, no personal settings. Every ask counted as a no.

ONE KEY

Shift+Tab switches the mode.

YOU SEE	WITHOUT ASKING, IT
⏸ manual mode on	only reads. It asks before each edit and command
⏸ plan mode on	reads and writes a plan. Your files stay as they are
▸▸ accept edits on	edits files. Other commands still ask

Anthropic: plan mode "tells Claude to research and propose changes without making them".

In our clean test it started in manual mode.

PLAN FIRST

The plan saw a trap. The quick fix fell in.

The plan: 199 lines, 7 columns, hidden line-end marks (Windows style) on every line.

Manual mode offered a one-line command instead (sed). We ran it on a copy:

```
...,delivered\r,no
```

The new value landed after the hidden line-end mark. The column broke.

26 seconds of plan. Nothing changed until we said so.

THE ASK SCREEN

Manual mode asks before each edit.

```
Do you want to make this edit to
shipments-export-sample.csv?
❯ 1. Yes
  2. Yes, and switch to accept edits
     (auto-approve file edits and common file
     commands) for this session (shift+tab)
  3. No

Esc to cancel · Tab to amend
```

Start with 1. Pick 2 when you trust the job.

UNDO A STEP

Esc twice. Then restore both.

```
❯ 1. Restore code and conversation
  2. Restore conversation
  3. Restore code
  ...
⚠ Rewinding does not affect files edited
  manually or via bash.
```

→ **Code only:** the file came back, but Claude still said "The checked column is already in the file"

→ **A shell command change (sed):** the screen said "The code will be unchanged." The file stayed changed

Rewind is a quick undo. Our real undo button is Git.

MY OWN SETUP

I run auto mode. You start with plan and manual.

MY OWN CLAUDE CODE	
Start mode	Auto
Rules	80 allow rules, 13 deny rules
Hooks	80,000+ hook checks since 3 Oct
A person	Security, money or delete decisions wait for me

FREE FILES

Get the one-page cheat sheet. Free.

→ The three modes, and when to use which

→ The ask screen, answer by answer

→ Rewind in 4 steps, and what it does not undo

→ The made-up export, to test on

On my profile, under Featured: AI Starter Kit, step 15.
Save this post.

Tomorrow: a second brain.